

SURIYA RAJAN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Data Engineer with over 8 years of experience architecting and building scalable, production-grade data platforms on AWS. Specialized in distributed systems, orchestration, and infrastructure as code, with deep expertise in Apache Spark, Airflow, and Terraform. Proven track record of optimizing data pipelines for performance and cost-efficiency, managing terabytes of data. Passionate about technical knowledge sharing through public blogging and open-source contributions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Big Data & Processing:** Apache Spark, AWS EMR, EMR Serverless, Hadoop, AWS Glue
- **Cloud Infrastructure (AWS):** S3, Lambda, EC2, IAM, VPC, CloudWatch, Athena
- **Orchestration & Workflow:** Apache Airflow (Certified)
- **Languages:** Python, Scala, SQL, Bash
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** Terraform, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nielsen | Data Engineer | Jun 2023 – Present

- **Cost & Performance Optimization:** Engineered optimizations for EMR Serverless provisioning, achieving a 40% reduction in processing costs and setup time.
- **Platform Modernization:** Led the migration of legacy Spark jobs to Spark 3.x, significantly enhancing execution speed and resource utilization.
- **Workflow Enhancement:** Streamlined Data Lake integrations and optimized complex Airflow DAGs to improve pipeline reliability and observability.

PDI Technologies | Data Engineer II | Dec 2021 – Jun 2023

- **Pipeline Architecture:** Designed and deployed automated ETL pipelines, integrating robust CI/CD workflows using GitHub Actions to accelerate deployment cycles.
- **Cloud Migration:** Spearheaded key AWS cloud migration projects, ensuring zero downtime and data integrity during transition.
- **Data Ingestion:** Revamped automated data ingestion processes from Windows servers, increasing data availability and system fault tolerance.

Tata Consultancy Services | Data Engineer | Aug 2017 – Dec 2021

- **System Engineer – Nielsen Media Analytics** (Aug 2019 – Dec 2021)
 - Developed high-performance ETL pipelines using Spark and Scala to handle large-scale media datasets.
 - Automated mission-critical workflows using Apache Airflow, reducing manual intervention.
 - Modernized infrastructure by migrating legacy systems to AWS using Terraform for Infrastructure as Code (IaC).
- **Assistant System Engineer – Nielsen Watch Analytics** (Aug 2017 – Aug 2019)
 - Architected hybrid data processing solutions bridging on-premise systems with AWS cloud resources.
 - Led the migration of version control systems from SVN to Git, improving team collaboration and code management.
 - Optimized complex SQL queries and executed large-scale data migrations to the cloud.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Apache Airflow Certified Data Engineer
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate